NULL SECTOR STUDIOS

WARD 0

3D DEEP MINE QUARANTINE & DIAGNOSTIC PSYCHOLOGICAL HORROR

Document: Written Game Pitch & Proposal
Date: October 2026
Engine: Unity 3D (URP)
Target Platform: PC (Steam)

1. TEAM INTRODUCTION: WHO ARE WE?

NULL SECTOR STUDIOS

Who Are We & Our Connection to Games: We are **Null Sector Studios**, a dedicated four-member team of senior computer engineering students: **Hasan Can Zorlu, Hüseyin Köroğlu, Görkem Eren, and Fikret Karakuzu**. While this project marks our first time building a full 3D title inside a commercial game engine, we are lifelong players of atmospheric PC thrillers, tactical simulations, and visceral survival horror titles like *Outlast*. Watching how compact, system-driven indie titles captivate both players and streaming communities inspired us to design an adult, tension-filled 3D deep-mine quarantine experience built on strong software engineering foundations.

Why This Course & What We Expect by the End of the Semester: We enrolled in the GameTech course to translate our core software engineering, computer vision, and state-machine architecture skills into real-time 3D interactive systems. Throughout the semester, we expect to master the Unity Universal Render Pipeline (URP), multi-spectral camera rendering, custom sanity post-processing shaders, and 3D raycast mechanics by combining curated 3D asset packs with modern AI-assisted coding workflows. By strictly controlling our project scope—concentrating all detail inside an armored mine quarantine checkpoint and compact, task-specific modular mine tunnels rather than an overambitious open world—we aim to finish the semester with a bug-free, commercially viable indie horror game ready for a public Steam launch.

TEAM MEMBER	PRIMARY ENGINEERING ROLE	ARTISTIC SIDE & PRODUCTION RESPONSIBILITIES
Hasan Can Zorlu	Core Gameplay, 3D Raycast & Camera Lead	**Modeling & Camera Pipeline:** Integrates 3D diagnostic instruments, configures Render-to-Texture CCTV feeds, scripts X-Ray Layer Culling Masks, and codes sanity-induced camera sway & visual occlusion triggers.
Hüseyin Köroğlu	Procedural Systems & State Machine Architect	**Graphic Design & UI/UX:** Designs studio/game logos and protocol binders; codes the deterministic C# miner symptom matrix, dual-source sanity state machine, and scripted FOV enemy sequences.
Görkem Eren	3D Environment, Lighting & Level Designer	**3D Scene & Animation Setup:** Assembles the armored checkpoint and task-specific modular mine tunnels, places navigation landmarks, scripts steam-occluded corridor prefab swapping, and rigs Mixamo miner animations.
Fikret Karakuzu	Technical Artist, Shaders & Audio Designer	**Sound/Music & Shaders:** Engineers 3D spatial audio (hallucinatory screams, whispers, panic breathing, steam bursts) and authors Thermal/UV Shader Graphs plus URP sanity post-processing filters.

2. CONCISE GAME DESCRIPTION

EXACT WORD COUNT: 93 WORDS (STRICT 50–100 WORD COMPLIANCE)

WARD 0 is a 3D first-person biological quarantine and diagnostic psychological horror game set at the armored checkpoint of a deep underground mining facility. Following a catastrophic neurotoxic gas leak that turned miners into violent, paranoid hosts akin to *Outlast*, you play as the shift technician evaluating evacuated workers behind reinforced glass. Using diegetic 3D scanners (X-Ray, Thermal, UV, and ECG), you must clear healthy miners or incinerate infected ones. Clearing an infected worker causes instant death, while incinerating an innocent miner inflicts permanent sanity loss, severely impairing perception inside shifting mine tunnels.

3. DESCRIPTION OF CORE GAMEPLAY & MECHANICS

EXACT WORD COUNT: 92 WORDS (STRICT 50–100 WORD COMPLIANCE)

Gameplay alternates between upper-level quarantine triage and lower-level mine maintenance using 100% diegetic 3D instruments. Inside the booth, players operate X-Ray, Thermal, UV, and ECG scanners, occasionally entering the cell to draw blood samples before pulling the Clear or Incinerate lever. Clearing an infected miner causes instant death, while incinerating a healthy worker permanently drains sanity. During facility breakdowns, players descend into task-specific modular mine tunnels to repair valves and breakers. Steam bursts visually occlude the camera, triggering non-Euclidean corridor swapping that demands landmark-based memory navigation and hiding from scripted FOV patrols.

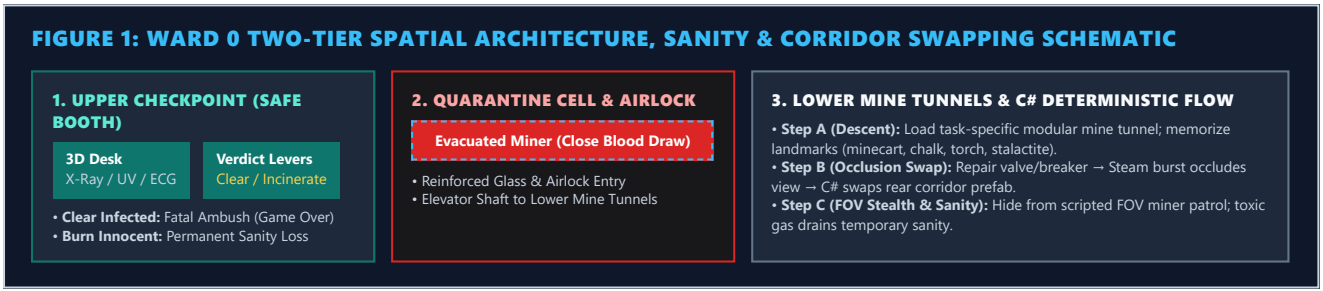
Technical Implementation in Unity URP

- **Multi-Spectral Culling & Shaders:** Secondary cameras use Unity Layer Masks to project internal skeletal anomalies onto CRT monitors via Render-to-Texture, while custom UV and Thermal Shader Graphs expose sub-dermal neurotoxic veins and abnormal organ heat signatures.
- **Dual-Source Sanity & Post-Processing:** Sanity permanently drops when incinerating innocent miners and temporarily decays in toxic mine gas (recovering upon returning upstairs). Crossing sanity thresholds triggers URP Vignette, silhouettes, camera sway, heavy movement penalties, and 3D spatial audio whispers/screams.

Deterministic Horror (Zero Pathfinding Bugs)

- **Visual Occlusion & Non-Euclidean Swapping:** Compact, task-specific modular mine tunnels load per repair mission. When repairing a valve or breaker, a dense steam burst or spark flash occludes player vision while C# scripts silently swap rear corridor prefabs—requiring landmark-based memory navigation (minecarts, chalk marks, torches, stalactites) to return.
- **Scripted FOV Encounters & Cell Entry:** No fragile NavMesh AI is used. Delusional miners spawn outside player FOV, patrol deterministic paths while players hide in alcoves or behind minecarts, and despawn out of sight. Up-close blood draws inside the cell trigger high-tension micro-jumpscares.

FIGURE 1: WARD 0 TWO-TIER SPATIAL ARCHITECTURE, SANITY & CORRIDOR SWAPPING SCHEMATIC



4. MARKET POTENTIAL, TARGET AUDIENCE & 4 SIMILAR GAMES

EXACT WORD COUNT: 88 WORDS (STRICT 50–100 WORD COMPLIANCE)

WARD 0 targets mature PC gamers (ages 18–34) and Twitch/YouTube streamers drawn to high-tension diagnostic horror, anomaly observation, and visceral survival thrillers like *Outlast*. Market data confirms that system-driven indie horror achieves exceptional commercial returns on Steam: *The Mortuary Assistant* generated over $9.3M gross revenue (527K+ copies sold), *The Exit 8* sold 908K+ copies ($2.9M+ gross), and *Contraband Police* exceeded $44.1M. By fusing high-stakes mine quarantine triage, permanent sanity consequences, and disorienting non-Euclidean corridor swapping, **WARD 0** delivers intense streamer reactions, high replayability, and strong Steam wishlist conversion.

GAME TITLE	VISUALS & VIEW	CORE THEME	PRIMARY MECHANICS	STEAM FINANCIALS & WARD 0 EDGE
1. The Mortuary Assistant	3D First-Person Realistic	Demonic Morgue Autopsy	Embalming prep & occult sigil matching	**$9.3M+ Gross (527K Sold, 92% Pos.)** Ward 0 uses live bio-scanners (X-Ray/UV) & dual-source sanity decay.
2. Papers, Please	2D Pixel Art Checkpoint	Totalitarian Border Control	Rulebook cross-checking & stamping	**$33.7M+ Gross (4.9M Sold, 97% Pos.)** Evolves 2D triage into 3D survival horror with fatal or sanity-draining verdicts.
3. Contraband Police	3D First-Person Simulation	1980s Border Smuggling	UV light & physical vehicle inspection	**$44.1M+ Gross (95% Overwhelm. Pos.)** Applies 3D forensic inspection to neurotoxic miners & close-quarters blood draws.
4. The Exit 8	3D First-Person Liminal	Subway Anomaly Loop	Passive visual anomaly spotting	**$2.9M+ Gross (908K Sold, 93% Pos.)** Replaces passive loops with steam-occluded corridor swapping & landmark memory.
WARD 0 (Our Project)	**3D Diegetic Mine & Booth**	**Deep Mine Quarantine Horror**	**3D scanners, sanity, corridor swap & stealth**	**Commercial Steam Target Zero 2D menus + landmark navigation, dual sanity & scripted FOV stealth.**

5. DESCRIPTION OF INNOVATION AND CREATIVITY

EXACT WORD COUNT: 88 WORDS (STRICT 50–100 WORD COMPLIANCE)

Unlike passive anomaly spotters or static 2D desk simulators, **WARD 0** innovates by uniting 100% diegetic 3D quarantine triage with dual-source sanity degradation and non-Euclidean spatial manipulation. Every moral error permanently scars your psyche: incinerating an innocent miner irreversibly lowers your sanity baseline, compounding temporary neurotoxic gas decay during underground repairs. As sanity crosses critical thresholds, URP post-processing triggers severe vignette, camera sway, heavy movement penalties, and spatial auditory hallucinations. Combined with visual-occlusion corridor swapping and landmark-based memory navigation, analytical deduction seamlessly transforms into intense psychological survival horror.

6. 12-WEEK WORK PLAN & GANTT SCHEDULE

WBS MILESTONE ROADMAP

WBS	MILESTONE & CORE DELIVERABLES	OWNER	W1–W2	W3–W5	W6–W9	W10–W12
1.0	**Proposal, Mine Quarantine Concept, Asset Selection & Greybox**	All 4 Members	**100% Done**	—	—	—
2.1	Demo I: Armored Checkpoint, Task-Specific Mine Tunnels & Raycast	Hüseyin & Can	—	**Active**	—	—
2.2	Demo I: Render-to-Texture CCTV, 3D Bio-Scanners & Cell Blood Draw	Görkem & Fikret	—	**Active**	—	—
3.1	Demo II: Steam-Occluded Corridor Swapping, Landmarks & FOV Stealth	Can & Görkem	—	—	**Scheduled**	—
3.2	Demo II: Dual-Source Sanity System, URP Post-Processing & 3D Audio	Hüseyin & Fikret	—	—	**Scheduled**	—
4.0	**Final Release: Shift Progression, Sanity Balancing, QA & Trailer**	**All 4 Members**	—	—	—	**Final Launch**